

Student Digital Ambassador

Project Report

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Introduction

As a newly selected Student Digital Ambassador, I have developed this portfolio to demonstrate essential digital literacy skills. This report documents five tasks aimed at helping peers navigate professional profiles, safe communication, and cyber security. The role of a Student Digital Ambassador is to act as a peer educator, bridging the gap between university digital resources and students who may not be fully aware of best online practices. Through these tasks, I aim to raise awareness about responsible digital citizenship, build confidence in using professional platforms such as LinkedIn, and equip fellow students with the knowledge to protect themselves online. Each task has been designed to be practical, accessible, and directly applicable to the everyday digital challenges faced by students in an academic and professional environment.

Task 1: Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For this task, I designed a one-page visual resource titled "The Student's Digital Compass" using **Canva**. The infographic is designed to serve as a quick-reference guide for my peers at VIT Bhopal. It covers three essential modules: **Safe Internet Practices**, **Professional Online Presence**, and **Email Etiquette**.

The design uses a clean, vertical flow to separate technical safety (like 2FA and unique passwords) from career-building strategies (like LinkedIn optimization). I included a "Do's and Don'ts" section at the bottom to provide actionable takeaways that are easy to remember.

One thing I found particularly interesting while making this was researching the statistics—specifically that 87% of recruiters check social profiles before hiring. This realization shaped how I approached the "Professional Presence" section. The most difficult part was condensing complex security advice into short, punchy bullet points that wouldn't overwhelm a student reader.

Task 2: Digital Portfolio Reflection

For this task, I established my professional digital presence on **GitHub**, **LinkedIn**, and **HackerRank**. I chose these platforms because they are the most recognized tools for engineering students to showcase technical skills and build professional networks.

On GitHub, I created a profile README to serve as my digital introduction to the coding community. On LinkedIn, I updated my education details to show my enrollment in the B.Tech program at VIT Bhopal, which will help me connect with alumni and industry professionals. Finally, I set up a HackerRank profile to track my progress in competitive programming.

Over the next four years of my B.Tech, I plan to use GitHub to host all my course projects and LinkedIn to search for summer internships. HackerRank will be my primary tool for practicing data structures and algorithms to prepare for future placements. These profiles form the foundation of my professional identity as an engineer.

Task 3 Write-up: Coding & Collaboration Platforms

For the third module of this course, I focused on building technical proficiency and digital collaboration skills by utilizing two distinct platforms: **HackerRank** and **Google Workspace**.

In the first part of the task, I used **HackerRank** to solve the "Solve Me First" challenge. This exercise required me to implement a simple Python function to compute the sum of two integers. Through this, I practiced navigating a professional coding environment and understanding how to pass automated test cases. In the second part, I developed a **Google Form** titled "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" consisting of five questions, including both multiple-choice and short-answer formats. I also successfully linked this form to a **Google Sheet** to manage and analyze potential responses.

As a B.Tech student, these tools are essential for my academic journey. HackerRank provides a structured way to improve my logic and coding speed, which is critical for future placements. Meanwhile, mastering Google Workspace ensures I can collaborate effectively on group projects and conduct data-driven research. This task reinforced the idea that digital literacy is not just about using tools, but about choosing the right platform for the right task.

Task 4 Write-up: Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

In this task, I practiced the art of professional digital communication by drafting two essential emails: an assignment extension request to a professor and an internship inquiry to a coordinator. I focused on maintaining a formal tone, using clear subject lines, and ensuring a proper structure with appropriate salutations and sign-offs. I also developed a comprehensive social media checklist to promote responsible online behavior among my peers.

A real-world example of poor digital communication is when a student sends an email with a vague subject line like "Query" or no subject at all. In a high-volume academic environment, such emails are often ignored or marked as spam, leading to missed deadlines or lost opportunities. To prevent this, I learned that digital communication must always be concise, purposeful, and respectful of the recipient's time. Clear communication is the foundation of a professional digital identity.

Task 5 Write-up: Cybercrime Awareness

While researching UPI fraud for this task, I was surprised to learn how scammers use psychological pressure—like urgency and greed—to make even tech-savvy students ignore basic security rules. The most startling fact was that many people still believe a UPI PIN is required to receive money.

As a result of this research, I will personally change my habit of scanning QR codes sent by unknown individuals without verifying the transaction type first. I have also saved the National Cyber Crime Helpline number (1930) in my contacts to ensure I can act quickly or help a peer in case of an emergency. This task highlighted that being "digitally literate" means staying skeptical and protecting my financial data as much as my academic data.